

Mobile Development

Ideas + Business Models + Design

LAB 2/W3

3ND YEAR - ENSIA

OBJECTIVES

- Learn Techniques of how to search and validate ideas for mobile applications
- Analyze Existing Mobile Apps and Exploring Business Models.
- Designing New Apps with respect to design principles.

TASKS BEFORE THE LAB

- Search and write down 4 ideas for mobile apps. You can register for an account at [Flippa.com](https://flippa.com) and explore recently sold mobile Apps on Flippa.com
- Install the following Apps on your phone and explore what they offer.
 - <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.totalketodiet.ketodiet>
 - https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=dz.sebrou.docts_guide.app
- Collect much details from these websites :
 - <https://www.dropbox.com/scl/fi/jx3xecpk3kkxij2x1fnai/KETO.zip?rlkey=9hr9ygjvek677581rtrys4a&st=mt0hfa53&dl=1>
- Familiarize yourself with Figma :
 - Open an account with Figma (Or any equivalent software) and start to familiarize yourself with the design process.

TEAM EXERCISES (3 students Max)

Task / Exercise C1 (Market Research & Review of Apps) [30 mins + 15 mins class discuss]:

For the Keto Diet App:

- <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.totalketodiet.ketodiet>
- <https://www.dropbox.com/scl/fi/jx3xecpk3kkxij2x1fnai/KETO.zip?rlkey=9hr9ygjvek677581rtrys4a&st=mt0hfa53&dl=1>

Discuss and **write down answers** to the following points:

- Main Idea of the App
- Primary users/Audience of the App
- Problem being solved
- Main Functionalities
- Business Model of the App
- Sources/Amount of the Revenue.
- Expenses/Costs of running the App.
- Annual Net Profit of the App.
- Statistics (#Downloads, Age/App creation year, #Reviews, Rating Score)
- Any external APIs/Services being used.

Task / Exercise C2 (Strategies & Planning) [30 mins + 15 mins Discuss]:

In teams, for only **one** idea you have searched before the lab session, discuss how you can make a successful mobile app business via answering the following questions.

Write down the answers:

Market Research & Strategy

1. Write the problem/mission statement ONE LINE.
2. Why the problem is important to solve.

3. Who are the types of your potential app users? potential market size ?
4. List three app competitors addressing the same problem
5. Why you strongly believe that you can penetrate the market
6. What's the strategy to entice users to download the app
7. What's the strategy to keep your users engaged with the app and preserve a high retention rate.
8. What business model you will apply in the future

Analysis & Planning

1. List the main functionalities that the app would offer
2. Sketch a timeline for the various milestones of the project
3. Write down the list of expenses needed to develop and maintain the app.

If you don't have any idea in mind. Use the following idea:

- **Multiplayer Snake Game** (Each player has its own snake + they play on their own phone)

Task / Exercise C3 (Mobile App Design : Spotting Issues) [30 mins + 10 mins Discuss] :

Install the mobile app [أطباء الجزائر] [

https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=dz.sebrou.docts_guide.app]

Try to find the design errors which violate the following design principles:

1. Cut out the clutter
2. Design finger-friendly tap-targets
3. Text content should be legible
4. Design controls based on hand position
5. Minimize need for typing
6. Allowing flexible input
7. Providing smart defaults
8. Support direct manipulation
9. Ease of use
10. Navigation models
11. Offer informative feedback
12. Permit easy reversal of action
13. Make users feel in control
14. Communicate in the user's terms
15. Make it impossible to use it incorrectly

INDIVIDUAL EXERCISES

Task / Exercise C4 (Design of Mobile Apps) [50 mins]:

Use Figma (or any equivalent software [InVision, Adobe XD, Marvel, UXPin, Moqups..] or even Pencil & Paper) to design at least three screens for the various functionalities of the following app idea:

- App Idea : Multi-user Family Expense Tracker.
- Problem/Mission Statement : Control and monitor how much is being spent to avoid going overdraft and plan ahead.
- Audience : Parents
- Main Functionalities :
 - Add an Expense with a category, family member, date, description, amount
 - Add recurring expenses
 - Add income
 - See monthly reports and stats
 - Invite other users (either with add/edit or read-only mode)
- Business Model : Freemium + Ads

Explain how you comply with the design principles list above.

Important : You can use Design UI Kit inside Figma to speed up the design process.

You may look into other templates at Figma and re-use their components/widgets :

https://www.figma.com/community/search?resource_type=files&sort_by=relevancy&query=expense&editor_type=all&price=free&creators=all

You can open this template inside your Figma account :

<https://www.figma.com/community/file/1035203688168086460>

[Students who have finished the in-class exercises, shall proceed with the following exercises in class]

OPTIONAL EXERCISES

Task / Exercise P1 :

What business model is being considered by the developer of this app :

<https://codecanyon.net/item/android-news-app/10771397>

Task / Exercise P2 :

In the same way as Exercise C1, Study and analyze the following App.

- OCR Image to Text Converter
 - <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.appsuite.imagetotext>
 - <https://flippa.com/11635532-ocr-image-to-text-converter>

Task / Exercise P3 (Recommended) :

Install and explore the app : BrainerX (

<https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.brainerx.app&pli=1> Web : <https://brainerx.com/>) and answer the following questions:

- Who is behind this App ?
- What's the business model for this app ?
- Can you spot UI design Issues ?
- Do you think that this app will be successful at one in the future ? Why ?

Answer the same questions for the app (Krello :

<https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.crewmates.krello> , Web : Krello.net)

Task / Exercise P4 :

Visit <https://rapidapi.com/hub> and explore different API services that can be useful to build a mobile app.

Task / Exercise P5 :

Visit the following website and explore the top Apps being used in Egypt:

- <https://appfigures.com/top-apps/google-play/egypt/top-apps>

Do you think you get some idea on developing an App for your local market ?

Task / Exercise P6 :

Explore the following keywords finder tools :

- <https://www.mangools.com>
- <https://backlinko.com/tools/keyword>
- <https://keywordtool.io/>
- www.wordtracker.com
- <https://ahrefs.com/keyword-generator>

Task / Exercise P7 :

Create a free account with <https://www.adalo.com> and create a Todo App + test it from the web